

Weight Watch



Myth: Revamp your diet totally to control weight.

Fact: Changing too much, too fast and too soon won't help. Look for ways to include essential foods so that they become easy to incorporate into your eating plan. For example, if you find eating sufficient fruits difficult, make yourself a smoothie.



Myth: Eliminate certain food groups to lose weight.

Fact: That can only be a short-term goal. Remember, your body needs a balanced diet—fruits, vegetables, grains, nuts, sprouts, seeds and low-fat dairy products.

53%

OF MARRIED INDIAN WOMEN USE SOME FORM OF CONTRACEPTION AS OPPOSED TO A MERE 6% OF MEN.

■ Compiled by Damayanti Datta

Prevention is Better Than Cure



"We still can't get an adequate safe contraceptive but men can walk on the moon"—that has been the pet feminist peeve since the 1970s. But things may just look up for women in India with the launch of the first vaginal birth control ring by Organon Inc. this month. The small, flexible, transparent ring (made of ethylene-vinyl acetate copolymers) is easy to use and can be discreetly administered by a woman in the privacy of her home. It provides month-long protection by releasing low doses of hormones—progestin and estrogen—over three weeks. Welcome news in a country where men prefer to decide the size of the family and leave the burden of contraception to women.

MOTHER OF RISKS

Women who go for a baby soon after marriage are more likely to have problematic pregnancies and unhealthy babies, according to researchers at Auckland University in New Zealand. Published in the *Journal of Reproductive Immunology*, the study reports that women who become pregnant within days or weeks after marriage are up to three times as likely to suffer from pre-eclampsia, a potentially life-threatening condition that claims the lives of up to 1,000 babies and over 10 mothers a year all over the world.



The Deadliest Combination



Obesity, high blood pressure and high blood sugar are being called the "three killer indicators"—the most dangerous combination of health factors. In a study published in the American Heart Association journal, *Circulation*, researchers from the University of Warwick, UK, report that people with all three are twice as likely to have heart attacks and three times more likely to die earlier than the general population.